



Browser WARS

With the growth of the Internet, there has been a considerable increase in the number of Web browsers available for the Linux/BSD/Solaris platforms.

Not so long ago, in this world of FOSS, there used to be a time when the term 'Web browser' signified only a few text-based browsers. Nobody needed to run pop-up blockers, and Flash was just another comic book character. Yet, who cared! It was simple and minimal—right? Move on to the present day. Things have changed in a big way. We have innumerable open source browsers. The only thing that remains unchanged since the 1990s is that IE is still boring!

Now coming to the point: which is the best choice to surf the Web? No, I am not going to answer that here, but I will help you make that decision yourself. After all, FOSS is about helping and sharing, right?

With the ever-increasing number of browsers available, users are bound to feel

pampered. Gone are the days when Mozilla Firefox was the *de facto* Web browser bundled with every distro; there's talk of Google Chrome being included in upcoming releases of several distros. So without further ado, let's plunge into exploring the list of Web browsers.

Mozilla Firefox

You can hardly speak of the Internet without mentioning Firefox in the same breath. The world's second-most-used Web browser boasts of features such as tabbed browsing, spell-checking, incremental search, live bookmarks, a download manager, and much more. Besides, the Firefox community keeps adding new and innovative features to enhance the browsing experience. Shipped with almost every distro, Firefox will be your safest bet for browsing!